INCH-POUND

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April 8, 1993
SUPERSEDING
A-A-20112
August 10, 1988

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

NOODLES, CHOW MEIN

The U.S. Department of Agriculture has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description in preference to Military Specification MIL-N-43158.

This Commercial Item Description (CID) covers chow mein noodles, packed in commercially acceptable containers, suitable for use by the Federal Government.

Salient characteristics.

Chow mein noodles shall be prepared from unbleached, enriched wheat flour, water, and salt, which are processed and heated in partially hydrogenated vegetable oil (soybean or cottonseed). Yeast may be used as an optional ingredient.

The chow mein noodles shall be thin, approximately 1/8 inch in diameter and 1-1/2 inches in length. Chow mein noodles shall be free from discolored or burnt units.

The finished product shall possess a fresh toasted wheat-like flavor and aroma, a golden-brown color, and a crispy and tender texture with a light crunch. The chow mein noodles shall be free from rancid, oxidized flavors and odors. The chow mein noodles shall comply with the following requirements:

Moisture	not more than 3.0 percent
Fat	not less than 22.0 percent and not more than 28.0 percent
Salt	not more than 2.5 percent

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc. and any data which may improve this document should be sent to: Commander, U.S. Army Natick Research, Development, and Engineering Center, ATTN: SATNC-WTP, Natick, MA 01760-5018.

FSC 8920

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Analytical requirements.

Chemical analysis shall be made in accordance with the following methods in the Official Methods of Analysis of AOAC International.

Test	Chapter and Section	Paragraph Numbers
Moisture	Chapter: Cereal Foods Section: Macaroni, Egg Noodles and Similar Products	926.07
Fat	Chapter: Meat and Meat Products	960.39, 976.21, 985.15
Salt	Chapter: Meat and Meat Products	935.47

Contractor's certification.

By submitting an offer, the contractor certifies that the product offered meets the specified salient characteristics and requirements of this CID; conforms to the producer's own specifications and standards, including product characteristics, manufacturing procedures, quality control procedures, and storage and handling practices; has a national or regional distribution from storage facilities located within the United States, its territories, or possessions; and is sold on the commercial market. The Government reserves the right to determine proof of such conformance prior to the first delivery from point of origin and any time thereafter, up to and including delivery at final destination, as may be necessary to determine conformance with the provisions of the contract.

Regulatory requirements.

The delivered product shall comply with all applicable Federal and State mandatory requirements and regulations relating to the preparation, packaging, labeling, storage, distribution, and sales of the product in the commercial marketplace. All deliveries shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

Quality assurance.

When required in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order, the Federal Grain Inspection Service (FGIS), U.S. Department of Agriculture, will determine the quality assurance of the chow mein noodles according to FGIS procedures. The product shall be examined or analyzed as applicable in accordance with provisions in the CID, and when applicable, the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers currently in effect on the date of the solicitation.

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Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking.

The chow mein noodles shall be preserved, packaged, packed, labeled, and case marked in accordance with good commercial practice. Commercial labeling and packaging, as may be augmented by the solicitation, contract, or purchase order, shall be acceptable. Shipping containers shall comply with the National Motor Freight Classification or Uniform Freight Classification, as applicable.

For Department of Defense procurements (Only).

The following requirements are applicable when specified by the contracting officer.

A. Commercial packaging. Twenty-four ounces of product shall be packaged in a size 603 x 700 metal can. The can shall be hermetically sealed under an atmosphere of nitrogen. Alternatively, the air shall be evacuated from the can before sealing to obtain a gauge vacuum of not less than 26 inches of mercury.

B. Commercial packing. Cans shall be packed in fiberboard shipping containers complying with Uniform Freight Classification or National Motor Freight Classification.

C. Export packaging. Twenty-four ounces of product shall be packaged in a size 603 x 700 open-top style, round, metal can. The can shall have a soldered or welded side seam and compound-lined, double-seamed ends. Cans shall have tinplating weights of minimum 0.20 pounds per base box. Alternatively, can ends may be fabricated from ECCS plate, enameled both inside and out. The cans shall be hermetically sealed under an atmosphere of nitrogen or under sufficient vacuum so the oxygen content in the can does not exceed 2 percent.

D. Export packing. Six cans of product shall be packed in a fiberboard shipping container constructed, closed, and reinforced in accordance with Style RSC-L, Grade W5c, W5s, or V3c of PPP-B-636. The shipping container shall be fitted with weather-resistant grade fiberboard inner packing to afford protection to the cans in transit and storage. Reinforcement shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping or pressure-sensitive adhesive, filament-reinforced tape.

E. Unit loads (commercial and export). Shipping containers shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with MIL-L-35078. When unit loads are strapped, strapping shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping, except for Type II, Class F loads.

F. Labeling (commercial and export). Commercial labeling shall be acceptable.

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G. Marking (commercial and export). Marking of shipping container and unit loads shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

The following tests and examinations are applicable to Department of Defense procurements of Operational Rations. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105, Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.

Pouch material certification. A certificate of compliance may be accepted as evidence that the characteristics listed below conform to the specified requirements.

Material requirement	Requirement paragraph	Test procedure
Thickness of films	H(2) and H(4)	As specified in L-P-378, Plastic Sheet and Strip, Thin Gauge, Polyolefin, except that a machinist's micrometer may be used provided that its graduations and accuracy conform to the requirements L-P-378.
Aluminum foil thickness	H(2) and H(4)	As specified in QQ-A-1876, Aluminum Foil.
Laminated material identification and construction	H(2) and H(4)	Laboratory evaluation.
Color of laminated material	H(2)	Visual evaluation.

Unfilled preformed pouch certification. A certificate of compliance may be accepted as evidence that unfilled pouches conform to the requirements specified in packaging paragraph H. When deemed necessary by the USDA, testing of the unfilled preformed pouches for seal strength shall be as specified as follows:

Unfilled preformed pouch seal strength testing. The unfilled pouches shall be tested for seal strength in accordance with ASTM F 88, except that the specimen holding clamps shall be spaced 2 inches apart prior to testing and the testing speed shall be 10 or 12 inches per minute. Machines that apply the tensile load to the test specimen by movement of the upper or lower clamp may be used. Test specimens shall be cut 1/2 or 1 inch in width and to a length suitable for proper mounting. The lot size shall be expressed in pouches. The sample size shall be the number of pouches indicated by inspection level S-1. Three adjacent specimens shall be cut from each of the three sealed sides of each pouch in the sample. The results shall be reported

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to the nearest 0.1 pound. The average seal strength of each seal shall be calculated by averaging the strengths of the three test specimens cut from that seal. Any test specimen failing to meet the individual test specimen seal strength requirement or any seal failing to meet the average seal strength requirement specified in H(2) shall be classified as a major defect and shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

Pouch closure seal strength testing. The filled and sealed pouches shall be tested for closure seal strength in accordance with ASTM F 88, except that the specimen holding clamps shall be spaced 2 inches apart prior to testing and the testing speed shall be 10 or 12 inches per minute. Machines that apply tensile load to the specimen by movement of the upper or lower clamp may be used. The test specimens shall be cut to a length suitable for proper mounting. Three adjacent specimens, 1/2 or 1 inch wide shall be cut from the closure seal of each pouch in the sample. The average seal strength of the closure seal shall be calculated by averaging the test results of the three test specimens cut from that seal. The results shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 pound per inch of width. The lot size shall be expressed in pouches. The sample unit shall be one filled and sealed pouch. The sample size shall be the number of pouches indicated by inspection level S-1. Any individual test specimen or average closure seal strength failing to meet the requirements of H(3) or H(5) shall be classified as a major defect and shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

Filled and sealed pouch examination. The filled and sealed pouches shall be examined for the defects listed in Table I. The lot size shall be expressed in pouches. The sample unit shall be one filled and sealed pouch. The inspection level shall be I and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 0.65 for major defects and 2.5 for minor defects.

TABLE I. Filled and sealed pouch defects 1/

Category		Defect
Major	Minor	
101		Tear, hole, or open seal.
102		Pouch has foreign odor.
103		Not clean. 2/
104		Presence of delamination. 3/
105		Seal width less than 1/16 inch. 4/
	201	Presence of delamination. 3/
	202	Required labeling missing, incorrect, illegible, or smudged.
	203	Tear notch missing or does not facilitate easy opening.
	204	Closure or top seal extends into or below tear notch.

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not exceed the pressures shown in table 5-37 shall

1/ Any evidence of insect or rodent infestation shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

2/ Outer packaging shall be free from foreign matter which is unwholesome, has the potential to cause pouch damage (e.g., glass, metal filings, etc.) or generally detracts from the clean appearance of the package. The following examples shall not be scored as defects for unclean:

a. Foreign matter which presents no health hazard or potential pouch damage and which can be readily removed by gently shaking the package or by gently brushing the package with a clean, dry cloth.

b. Dried product which affects less than 1/8 of the total surface area of one pouch face (localized and aggregate).

c. Water spots.

d. Very thin film of grease, oil, or product residue which is discernible to touch, but is not readily discernible by visual examination.

3/ Major - Delamination of the outer ply in the pouch seal area that can be propagated to expose aluminum foil at the food product edge of the pouch after manual flexing of the delaminated area. To flex, the delaminated area shall be held between the thumb and forefinger of each hand with both thumbs and forefingers touching each other. The delaminated area shall then be rapidly flexed 10 times by rotating both hands in alternating clockwise-counter clockwise directions. Care shall be exercised when flexing delaminated areas near the tear notches to avoid tearing the pouch material. After flexing, the separated outer ply shall be grasped between thumb and forefinger and gently lifted toward the food product edge of the seal or if the separated area is too small to be held between thumb and forefinger, a number 2 stylus shall be inserted into the delaminated area and a gentle lifting force applied against the outer ply. If separation of the outer ply can be made to extend to the product edge of the seal with no discernible resistance to the gentle lifting, the delamination shall be scored as a major defect. Additionally, spot delamination of the outer ply in the body of the pouch that is able to be propagated beyond its initial borders is also a major defect. To determine if the delaminated area is a defect, use the following procedure: Mark the outside edges of the delaminated area using a bold permanent marking pen. Open the pouch and remove the contents. Cut the pouch transversely not closer than 1/4 inch ($\pm$ 1/16 inch) from the delaminated area. The pouch shall be flexed in the area in question using the procedure described above. Any propagation of the delaminated area, as evidenced by the delaminated area exceeding the limits of the outlined borders, shall be scored as a major defect.

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Minor - Minor delamination of the outer ply in the pouch seal area is acceptable and shall not be classified as a minor defect unless it extends to within 1/16 inch of the food product edge of the seal. All other minor outer ply delamination in the pouch seal area or isolated spots of delamination in the body of the pouch that do not propagate when flexed as described above shall be classified as minor defect.

4/ The effective closure seal is defined as any uncontaminated, fusion bonded, continuous path, minimum 1/16 inch wide, from side seal to side seal that produces a hermetically sealed pouch.

Product inspection. The filled and sealed sample pouches shall be inspected for defects indicated in Table II. The lot size shall be expressed in pouches. The sample unit shall be the contents of one pouch. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 1.5 for major defects and 2.5 for minor defects.

TABLE II. Product defects 1/

Category		Defect
Major	Minor	
101		Pouch does not contain one packet of oxygen scavenger.
102		Oxygen content in pouch exceeds 0.30 percent. 2/
103		Product does not conform to all salient characteristics. 3/ 4/
104		Broken oxygen scavenger packet.
	201	Pouch contains less than 7/8 ounce or more than 1-1/2 ounces of product.
105		Presence of stress cracks in the aluminum foil. 5/ 6/

1/ The presence of any foreign material (e.g., glass, dirt, insects, insect parts, hair, wood, metal), foreign odor or flavor (e.g., burnt, scorched, moldy, rancid, sour, stale), or foreign color shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

2/ Filled and sealed pouches shall be tested for oxygen content in accordance with any USDA approved test method. Testing for oxygen content shall be accomplished only after filled and sealed pouches have been allowed to equilibrate at room temperature for not less than 96 hours from time of sealing.

3/ Moisture, salt, and fat content shall be verified by the chow mein noodle supplier's certificate of conformance.

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4/ Pouches which contain any amount of broken, crushed or very small pieces which materially distracts from the overall good quality appearance and palatability of the product shall be classified as a major defect.

5/ Applicable to form-fill-seal pouches only.

6/ To test for stress cracks the inside surface of the tray-shaped body shall be placed over a high intensity light source and the outside surface observed for the passage of light. Observation of light through the pouch material in the form of a curved or straight line greater than 2 mm in length shall be evidence of the presence of stress cracks in the aluminum foil.

H. Operational ration component packaging. One ounce (+ 1/2 ounce, -1/8 ounce) of product and one packet of an FDA approved oxygen scavenger substance shall be heat sealed into a preformed pouch.

(1) Oxygen scavenger packet. The oxygen scavenger shall be FDA approved as suitable for use with food. The oxygen scavenger packet shall be resistant to the migration of oil, moisture, and scavenger components.

(2) Preformed pouch. The preformed pouch shall be fabricated from 0.002 inch thick ionomer or polyethylene film laminated or extrusion coated to 0.00035 inch thick aluminum foil which is then laminated to 0.0005 inch thick polyester. The three plies shall be laminated with the polyester on the exterior of the pouch. The complete exterior surface of the pouch shall be uniformly colored in the range of 34079 through 34087 or 24052 through 24087 or 30045 through 30118 (excluding 30109) or 10045 of FED-STD-595. The material shall be suitably formulated for food packaging and shall not impart an odor or flavor to the product being packed. The material shall show no evidence of delamination, degradation, or foreign odor when heat sealed or fabricated into pouches. The preformed pouch shall be a flat style pouch having inside dimensions of 5 inches wide by 7 inches long (± 1/8 inch). The first dimension is measured at the opening of the pouch between the heat sealed sides. The pouch shall be made by heat sealing three edges with 3/8 inch (± 1/8 inch) wide seals. The heat seals shall be made in a manner that will ensure hermetic seals. The side and bottom seals shall have an average seal strength of not less than 6 pounds per inch and no individual specimen shall have a seal strength of less than 5 pounds per inch when tested as specified in the unfilled preformed pouch seal strength test. A V-shaped or C-shaped (half round) tear notch at least 1/32 inch deep, located 1 to 1-1/4 inches from the top or bottom edge of the pouch, shall be made in one or both side seals. The distance between the inside edge of the tear notch and the inside edge of the seal shall be at least 3/16 inch. One side of the open end of the pouch may be provided with an extended or foldover lip, extended not more than 1/8 inch (± 1/16 inch) to facilitate opening and

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filling. Tear notch location shall be measured from the top or bottom of the pouch, excluding the extended or foldover lip.

(3) Preformed pouch filling and sealing. One ounce (+ 1/2 ounce, -1/8 ounce) of product shall be filled into the pouch and the pouch shall be closed with a continuous heat seal not less than 1/4 inch wide. If thermal impulse or combination (heated curved bar with thermal impulse) sealing is used, any seal width from 1/8 to 7/16 inch will be acceptable. The closure seal shall not extend below the tear notch on either side of the pouch. The average seal strength shall be not less than 6 pounds per linear inch, and no individual test specimen shall be less than 5 pounds when tested as specified in the pouch closure seal test. The oxygen content of the filled and sealed pouch shall not exceed 0.30 percent.

(4) Form-fill-seal pouch. The form-fill-seal pouch shall consist of a formed tray-shaped body with a flat-sheet, heat sealable cover or a tray-shaped body with a tray-shaped heat sealable cover. The tray-shaped body and the tray-shaped cover shall be fabricated from a 3-ply flexible laminate barrier material consisting of 0.0009 inch thick oriented polypropylene bonded to 0.0007 inch thick, deep-forming, aluminum foil with 10 pounds per ream pigmented polyethylene and bonding the opposite side of the aluminum foil to 0.003 inch thick ionomer or a blend of not less than 50 percent linear low density polyethylene and polyethylene. The linear low density portion of the blend shall be a copolymer of ethylene and octene-1, having a melt index range of 0.8 to 1.2 grams per 10 minutes in accordance with ASTM D 1238 and a density range of 0.918 to 0.922 G/CC in accordance with ASTM D 1505. Alternatively, 0.0005 inch thick polyester may be used in place of the oriented polypropylene as the outer ply of the laminate. The flat-sheet cover shall be made from the same 3-ply laminate, as specified for the tray-shaped body or tray-shaped cover, except that the aluminum foil thickness shall be 0.00035 inch. The color requirements of the exterior (oriented polypropylene or polyester side) of the laminates shall be as specified in H(2). The laminates shall be suitably formulated for food packaging and shall not impart any odor or flavor to the product being unit packed.

(5) Form-fill-seal pouch construction. The tray-shaped body and the tray-shaped cover shall be formed by drawing the flexible laminate material into an appropriately shaped cavity. The flat cover shall be in the form of a flat-sheet of the barrier material taken from roll-stock. One ounce (+ 1/2 ounce, -1/8 ounce) of product and one unit of an FDA approved oxygen scavenger shall be placed into the tray-shaped body of the pouch. Pouch closure shall be effected by heat sealing the flat cover or the tray-shaped cover to the tray-shaped body along the entire bag perimeter. The outside dimensions of the pouch shall not be greater than 5-1/2 inches in width and 7-3/8 inches in length. The closure seal shall not be less than 1/4 inch wide. The closure seal shall be free of entrapped matter (crumbs, grease, etc.) that reduces the effective closure

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seal to less than 1/16 inch wide. The closure seal shall have an average seal strength of not less than 6 pounds per inch of width and no individual specimen shall have a seal strength of less than 5 pounds per inch of width when tested in accordance with the pouch closure seal test. (Each seal made on the form-fill-seal machine is considered to be a closure seal.) One or two tear notches in accordance with H(2) shall be provided on the pouch outside edge to facilitate tear opening in the machine direction of the pouch laminate material. Alternatively, if the pouch has serrated edges, the serrations may be used as tear notches provided that the serrations are located to effect easy opening in the machine direction of the pouch laminates, the serrations are sharp (no plastic tailing exists), and the serration depth is adequate to facilitate easy opening of the bag and the seal width at the serrations is no less than 1/16 inch. The sealed pouch shall show no evidence of material degradation, aluminum stress cracking, delamination, or foreign odor when heat sealed into pouches.

I. Packing of product for shipment of government furnished material to ration assembler. Not more than 100 one ounce unit packs of product shall be packed on edge in a snug-fitting shipping container complying with the National Motor Freight Classification or Uniform Freight Classification, as specified.

J. Pouch labeling. The one ounce unit packs shall be clearly printed with permanent ink in large letters of black, purple, or similar dark contrasting color with the following information:

Noodles, Chow Mein
(name and address of producer)

Notes.

Sources of documents:

Sources of information for nongovernmental documents are as follows:

Copies of the National Motor Freight Classification may be obtained from:

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent
National Motor Freight Classification
American Trucking Associations, Inc., Traffic Department
2200 Mill Road
Alexandria, VA 22314

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Copies of the Uniform Freight Classification may be obtained from:

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent
Uniform Freight Classification
Uniform Classification Committee, Suite 1120
222 South Riverside Plaza
Chicago, IL 60606

Copies of the Official Methods of Analysis of AOAC International may be obtained from:

AOAC International
2200 Wilson Boulevard
Suite 400-CD
Arlington, VA 22201-3301

Sources of information for governmental documents are as follows:

Applicable provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act are contained in 21 CFR Parts 1 to 199. This three-volume set may be purchased from:

Superintendent of Documents
U.S. Government Printing Office
Washington, DC 20402-0001

Credit card (MasterCard or Visa) purchases may be made by calling the Superintendent of Documents on (202) 783-3238.

Copies of the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers are available from:

Chairperson
Condition of Container Committee
Agricultural Marketing Service
U.S. Department of Agriculture
Room 2506, South Building
P.O. Box 96456
Washington, DC 20090-6456

Civil agencies and other interested parties may obtain copies of this CID from:

General Services Administration
Specifications Unit (3FB-WS)
Room 6654
7th and D Streets, SW
Washington, DC 20407

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Military activities should submit requests for copies of this CID to:

Standardization Documents Order Desk
Building 4D
700 Robbins Avenue
Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 50

Review Activities

Army - MD, QM
Navy - MC
DP - SS

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

DOJ - BOP
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PREPARING ACTIVITY:

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